

Collectively, these new chips deliver significantly lower power, including more than 50 times reduction in idle power, more than 20 times reduction in audio power, and two-three times reductions across browsing and video



Intel Atom Processor Z6xx (Lincroft) and platform controller hub

scenarios—all at the platform level compared to Intel's previous-generation product. These power savings translate into more than ten days of standby, up to two days of audio playback and 4-5 hours of browsing and video battery life.

High-performing DSP core for multiple applications

Freemicro Semiconductor has introduced a family of programmable DSPs that deliver the optimal blend of low cost and high performance for a broad range of applications in the medical, aerospace/defence and test/measurement markets.

The fully programmable MSC825x DSP family scales from one to six cores, and helps to lower the system cost by as much as 50 per cent. It consists of four pin-compatible, single-, dual-, four- and six-core DSPs. Integrated features such as multiple DDR controllers, two Serial RapidIO interfaces and a PCI Express interface make designing with the MSC825x devices highly flexible. Pin and peripheral compatibility with Freescale's MSC815x family enables code and tool reuse and allows customers to scale from a single-

core device to multicore devices, or to create multiple products based on the same hardware.

The high processing performance of MSC825x DSPs enables additional channels for TETRA base stations, as well as advanced measurement capabilities for wireless communication testers.

Charge your mobile via a helmet

Two students of Ahmedabad's Nirma University—Pragnesh Dudhaiya and Aalok Bhatt—have created a helmet

that also functions as a mobile phone charger. This contraption charges a mobile in 40 minutes flat by using solar and wind energy. Dudhaiya and Bhatt are final-year students of electrical engineering and will soon file a patent for their innovation.

The idea was inspired by a rising number of fatal accidents of two-wheeler drivers who didn't wear helmets. During daytime, the helmet would use solar energy to charge the cellphone attached to it, while it would use wind energy in the night.

Indian students develop bomb-defusing robot

Bomb disposal teams across the world now have a new competitor. Two students from Sathagiri College of Engineering (SCE) have designed and developed a remote-controlled robot named Abhimanyu that defuses bombs. The robot is armed with a wireless camera, a flashlight, a gun, a laser beam and a fully operational tiny car.

Abhimanyu could also be used for military search operations, like patrolling sensitive areas that are curfew prone, and as a home security system. It is disabled-friendly, thanks to its flexible arms. People with disabilities can use the remote and monitor the robot's movements on a screen. They can thus get the robot to fetch items from around the house for them.

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